

LESSON 10

The Passive Voice

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–9

Lesson 9 introduced the **imperative** (direct commands), the **infinitive** (verbal noun / maṣdar), and the **l- + infinitive construction** for expressing purpose, ability, desire, and obligation. Before proceeding, confirm you can recall the following:

- **Imperative formation:** Peal msg = CCoC; fsg = CCoC+ī; mpl = CCoC+w; fpl = CCoC+ān
- **Negative commands:** lā + imperfect (never imperative)
- **Infinitive:** Peal = meCCaC; Paael = mCaCCāCū; Aphel = maCCāCū
- **Semi-modals:** šarī, yākel, bā ‘ ē, šābē, paqed, šadar — all govern l- + infinitive

Warm-Up Drill: Five Quick Questions

Answer in Syriac (Estrangela + transliteration).

#	QUESTION	EXPECTED ANSWER	SYRIAC
1	Give the Peal imperative m.sg. of ‘-z-l (go).	‘zel — go!	ܕܝܠ
2	How do you say “Do not kill!” (m.pl.)?	<i>lā teqṭlūn</i>	ܠܐ ܬܩܬܠܘܢ
3	What is the Peal infinitive of q-ṭ-l (kill)?	<i>meqṭal</i>	ܡܩܬܠܐ
4	Translate: <i>šarri l-mešma ‘</i> .	He began to hear.	ܫܪܝ ܠܡܫܡܐ
5	What does <i>puqdānā</i> mean?	commandment, command (noun from p-q-d)	ܩܘܕܢܐ

SECTION 2: THE PASSIVE/REFLEXIVE STEMS — OVERVIEW

2.1 The Principle of Passive Formation in Syriac

In Syriac, the passive voice is not expressed by auxiliary verbs (as in English: ‘is killed’, ‘was written’) but by a separate, **inflected stem** built from the active stem by means of a characteristic prefix: **’Et-** or **Et-**. These are called the **Et-stems**. Each active stem has a corresponding Et-stem that functions as its passive or reflexive counterpart.

Students of Hebrew will recognise an analogy with the **Niphal** (נִפְעַל, passive of Qal) and **Hitpael** (הִתְפַּעֵל, reflexive of Piel). Arabists will recognise the parallel with **Forms V, VI, VII, and VIII**: the tā ’-prefixed (تَفَعَّلَ) and n-prefixed (انْفَعَلَ) passives/reflexives. In Greek, the same **passive voice** forms (e.g., παίδεύομαι) serve the function. Latin uses separate passive endings (-or, -ris, -tur etc.).

2.2 The Three Et-Stems

ET-STEM NAME	ACTIVE COUNTERPART	PREFIX	MEANING / FUNCTION
Ethpeel ܐܬܦܥܠ	Peal	’et-	Passive or reflexive of Peal: ‘to be killed’, ‘to wash oneself’
Etpaael ܐܬܦܥܠ	Paael	’etpa-	Passive or reflexive of Paael: ‘to be blessed’, ‘to be sanctified’
Ettaphal ܐܬܦܥܠܐ	Aphel	’etta-	Passive of Aphel (causative): ‘to be saved’, ‘to be sent’

Cross-Linguistic Summary: Passive Formation

Syriac Ethpeel: ’et- + Peal root → parallel to Hebrew Niphal / Hitpael

Syriac Etpaael: ’etpa- + Paael → parallel to Arabic Form V تَفَعَّلَ

Syriac Ettaphal: ’etta- + Aphel → parallel to Arabic Form VII اِنْفَعَلَ

Greek: active + passive endings (same paradigm structure, different endings)

Latin: active vs. passive endings (-o/-or, -s/-ris, -t/-tur etc.)

SECTION 3: THE ETHPEEL STEM

3.1 Formation of the Ethpeel

The Ethpeel is formed by prefixing 'et- to the Peal root. The perfect stem is 'etCCeC. The participial form, which is very common, is metCCeC. In texts, the prefix may appear as 'et- or 'it- depending on dialect and vowelling.

Example: Root q-ṭ-l (kill) → Ethpeel perfect: 'etqṭel ሂቶላ 'he was killed'; Participle: metqṭel ሂቶሎ 'being killed'

3.2 Phonological Rules — Assimilation and Metathesis

When the Peal root begins with certain consonants, the t of the 'et- prefix undergoes phonological changes:

- **Before sibilants (z, s, š, ṣ): Metathesis** — the t and the sibilant swap positions. E.g., š-m- ' → 'et-šma ' becomes 'eš-t-ma ' ሂቶላ 'it was heard'; similarly 'et-z ' aq → 'ez-t- ' aq
- **Before dental/emphatic consonants (d, ṭ): Assimilation** — the t assimilates to the following consonant. E.g., d-k-y → 'et-dky becomes 'ed-dky (with doubling), sometimes written without the doubled letter.
- **Before all other consonants: No change** — e.g., q-ṭ-l → 'etqṭel; k-t-b → 'etkatteb

3.3 Full Paradigm: Ethpeel of q-ṭ-l (be killed)

Perfect (all 10 forms):

PERSON / NUMBER / GENDER	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭel	he was killed	
3fsg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelat	she was killed	d
2msg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelt	you (m.sg.) w	ere killed
2fsg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelti	you (f.sg.) w	ere killed
1sg	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelet	I was killed	
3mpl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelw	they (m.) wer	e killed
3fpl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭel(n)	they (f.) wer	e killed
2mpl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭeltūn	you (m.pl.) w	ere killed
2fpl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭeltēn	you (f.pl.) w	ere killed
1pl	ላቆሐጽ 'etqṭelan	we were killed	d

Participial Forms (Ethpeel Participle of q-ṭ-l):

FORM	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
Active Participle m.sg.	ላቆሐጽ metqṭel	being killed	(m.sg.)
Active Participle f.sg.	ላቆሐጽ metqṭelā	being killed	(f.sg.)
Active Participle m.pl.	ላቆሐጽ metqṭelīn	being killed	(m.pl.)
Active Participle f.pl.	ላቆሐጽ metqṭelān	being killed	(f.pl.)

SECTION 4: THE ETTAPHAL AND ETPAAEL STEMS

4.1 The Ettaphal — Passive of the Aphel

The **Ettaphal** is the passive counterpart of the Aphel (causative) stem. Its formation inserts 'etta- before the root. Since the Aphel adds the causative meaning ('to cause to X'), the Ettaphal means 'to be caused to X' — i.e., the passive of a causative, as in 'to be saved' (from 'to save'), 'to be sent' (from 'to send').

Example 1: Root ḥ-y-y / Aphel 'ahyī (save/give life) → Ettaphal: 'ettahyī ሠሐሐጽ 'he was saved / given life'

Example 2: Root 'l-p / Aphel 'alep (teach) → Ettaphal: 'ettalap ለእሱ 'he was taught'

Example 3: Root 'q-m / Aphel 'aqīm (raise up) → Ettaphal: 'ettaqam ጸዕኑ 'he was raised up'

Full Paradigm — Etpaael Perfect of š-d-r (be sent): (Paael *šaddar* 'send' → 'eštaddar; before š the t of 'et- swaps places with it)

PERSON / N / G	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ሰጸው 'eštaddar	he was sent	
3fsg	ሰጸች 'eštaddrat	she was sent	
2msg	ሰጸክ 'eštaddart	you (m.sg.)	were sent
1sg	ሰጸኝ 'eštaddret	I was sent	
3mpl	ሰጸው 'eštaddarw	they (m.) we	re sent
1pl	ሰጸን 'eštaddarn	we were sent	

4.2 The Etpaael — Passive/Reflexive of the Paael

The Etpaael is the passive or reflexive of the Paael (intensive/causative) stem. Its prefix is 'etpa-. Since the Paael often carries intensive meaning ('to bless greatly', 'to teach'), the Etpaael means 'to be blessed', 'to be taught', 'to be sanctified'. It can also be reflexive ('to sanctify oneself').

Example 1: Root b-r-k / Paael barrek (bless) → Etpaael: 'etbarrak ህጸኑ 'he was blessed'

Example 2: Root y-l-p / Paael yallep (teach) → Etpaael: 'etyallap ለእሱ 'he was taught / he learned'

Example 3: Root q-d-š / Paael qaddeš (sanctify) → Etpaael: 'etqaddaš ሠጸኑ 'he was sanctified / he sanctified himself'

Full Paradigm — Etpaael Perfect of b-r-k (be blessed):

PERSON / N / G	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	TRANSLATION
3msg	ኅቅሉ 'etbarrak	he was blesse	d
3fsg	ከቅሉ 'etbarkat	she was bless	ed
2msg	ከከቅሉ 'etbarkart	you (m.sg.) w	ere blessed
1sg	ከከቅሉ 'etbarkaret	I was blessed	
3mpl	ከቅሉ 'etbarkaw	they were ble	ssed
1pl	ከቅሉ 'etbarkan	we were bless	ed

SECTION 5: THE PASSIVE PARTICIPLE (PEAL)

5.1 Form and Usage

Distinct from the Ethpeel, the **Peal passive participle** is a simple adjectival form expressing a **completed passive state**: ‘written’ (ktīb), ‘killed’ (qtīl), ‘bound’ (‘sīr). Its pattern is **CāCoC** or in vocalized manuscripts **CCīC**. It agrees in gender and number with its noun, like any adjective. It is often used in **verbless clauses** with a predicative function: *gawrā qtīlā* ኅቅሉ ሰጠ = ‘the man is killed / the killed man’.

Students of Arabic will recognise the **passive participle (ism al-maf‘ ūl)**: مَقْتُولٌ maqtūl ‘killed’, مَكْتُوبٌ maktūb ‘written’. The Hebrew equivalent is **qāṭūl**: קָטוּל. The pattern is strikingly consistent across Semitic languages.

5.2 Passive Participles — Ten Key Verbs

ROOT	ESTRANGELA (M.SG.)	TRANSLIT. (M.SG.)	ESTRANGELA (F.SG.)	ENGLISH MEANING
<i>k-t-b</i>	כתב <i>ktīb</i>	*כתבת <i>ktībā</i>	written <i>kūbtā*</i>	
<i>q-ṭ-l</i>	قتل <i>qṭīl</i>	*قتלת <i>qṭīltā*</i>	killed, slain <i>qṭīltā*</i>	
<i>ʿ-s-r</i>	סר <i>ʿsīr</i>	*סרת <i>ʿsīrtā*</i>	bound, impris <i>ʿsīrtā*</i>	oned
<i>š-r-y</i>	שרי <i>šrī</i>	שרית <i>šrīyā</i>	loosed, relea <i>šrīyā*</i>	sed
<i>š-d-r</i>	שיר <i>šdīr</i>	*שירת <i>šdīrtā*</i>	sent <i>šdīrtā*</i>	
<i>p-q-d</i>	פקד <i>pqīd</i>	*פקדת <i>pqīdtā*</i>	commanded; co <i>pqīdtā*</i>	mmandment (noun)
<i>ʿ-m-d</i>	מדי <i>ʿmīd</i>	*מדת <i>ʿmīdtā*</i>	baptized (lit <i>ʿmīdtā*</i>	. ‘dipped’)
<i>š-l-b</i>	שלב <i>šlīb</i>	*שלבת <i>šlībtā*</i>	crucified; al <i>šlībtā*</i>	so: the cross
<i>q-b-r</i>	קבר <i>qbīr</i>	*קברת <i>qbīrtā*</i>	buried <i>qbīrtā*</i>	
<i>b-r-k</i>	ברך <i>brīk</i>	*ברכת <i>brīktā*</i>	blessed (adj. <i>brīktā*</i>	)

5.3 Passive Participle in Verbless Clauses

Examples of the passive participle used predicatively in verbless clauses:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
הוא *מת <i>gawrā qṭīlā*</i>	<i>gawrā qṭīlā*</i> m killed.m.sg	an.the T	he man is killed.
הוא *סר <i>Yūḥannan ʿsīr*</i>	<i>Yūḥannan ʿsīr*</i> Yu	khannan bound Yu	khannan is bound.
הוא *כתב <i>ketābā ktīb b-qūštā*</i>	<i>ketābā ktīb b-qūštā*</i> b written	ook.the T in truth. in-truth	he book is written
הוא *ברך <i>Mšīḥā brīk l-ʿālam*</i>	<i>Mšīḥā brīk l-ʿālam*</i> M blessed fore	essiah.the T ver blessed fore	he Messiah is ver.

SECTION 6: VOCABULARY — 30 WORDS (PASSIVE FOCUS)

These 30 words are central to Lesson 10 and to Syriac Christian literature generally. Each entry includes the basic (Peal) root, an Et-stem form where relevant, and the English meaning. Many are important

theological terms.

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
'-m-d	ܡܕܝܬܐ* / ܡܕܐ	'mad / 'et' med* b immerse)	aptize / to be baptized (dip,
g-l-y	ܓܠܝܬܐ* / ܓܠܐ	glā / 'etgli* r appear	eveal / to be revealed,
h-y-y / Aph.	ܚܝܝܬܐ* / ܚܝܐ	'ahyī / 'ethayyī* s	ave, give life / to be saved
q-t-l	ܩܬܠܐ* / ܩܬܐ	qṭal / 'etqṭel* k	ill / to be killed
'-s-r	ܥܣܪܐ* / ܥܣܐ	'asar / 'et' eser* b	ind / to be bound
š-r-y	ܫܪܝܬܐ* / ܫܪܐ	šrā / 'etšrī* l released	oosen / to be loosed,
š-d-r	ܫܕܪܐ* / ܫܕܐ	šaddar / 'eštaddar*	send / to be sent (Etpaael)
'-s-y	ܥܣܝܬܐ* / ܥܣܐ	'asī / 'et' asī* h	eal / to be healed
q-w-m / Aph.	ܩܘܡܝܬܐ* / ܩܘܡܐ	'aqīm / 'ettaqam* r (Ettaphal)	aise up / to be raised
k-n-š	ܬܬܝܬܐ* / ܬܬܐ	knaš / 'etkneš* g	ather / to be gathered
d-k-y	ܕܬܩܝܬܐ* / ܕܬܩܐ	dkā / 'etdkī* p	urify / to be purified
š-b-q	ܫܒܩܐ* / ܫܒܐ	šbaq / 'etšbaq* f forgiven	orgive, leave / to be
b-r-k	ܒܪܝܬܐ* / ܒܪܐ	barrek / 'etbarrak* b (Etpaael)	less (Paael) / to be blessed
y-l-p	ܝܠܠܐ* / ܝܠܐ	yallep / 'etyallap* t (Etpaael)	each (Paael) / to be taught
m-š-ḥ	ܡܫܚܐ* / ܡܫܐ	mšah / 'etmšah* a	noint / to be anointed
š-l-b	ܫܠܒܐ* / ܫܠܐ	šlab / 'etšlab* c	rucify / to be crucified
q-b-r	ܩܒܪܐ* / ܩܒܐ	qbar / 'etqbar* b	ury / to be buried
d-w-n / Aph.	ܕܠܝܬܐ* / ܕܠܐ	'addīn / 'ettaddīn* j (Ettaphal)	udge / to be judged
h-y-b	ܚܝܒܐ* / ܚܒܐ	ḥayyeb / 'ethayyab* c condemned	ondemn, make guilty / to be

ROOT	ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	ENGLISH
<i>p-r-q</i>	ܡܦܩܐ* / ܡܦܩ	praq / 'etpraq* r	edeem, save / to be redeemed
<i>k-l-l</i>	ܠܠܐܬܐ* / ܠܠܐ	kallel / 'etkallal* c	rown / to be crowned
<i>r-w-m / Aph.</i>	ܡܪܝܡ* / ܡܪܡ	'arīm / 'etrīm* e	xalt / to be exalted
<i>š-p-l</i>	ܠܦܬܐܠ* / ܠܦܬ	špel / 'etšpal* h	umiliate / to be humbled
<i>t-r-d</i>	ܬܪܝܬܐܠ* / ܬܪܬ	trad / 'ettrad* c out	ast out, expel / to be cast
'-w-d / Aph.	ܐܘܕܐܝܬܐܠ* / ܐܘܕܐܝܬܐ	confess, give	thanks (Aphel)
<i>t-w-b</i>	ܬܘܒܐ* / ܬܘܒ	tāb / tāyib* r (participle)	eturn, repent; repentant
<i>y-l-d</i>	ܠܕܐܠܐܬܐ* / ܠܕܐܠܐ	yled / 'etyled* g (Ethpeel)	ive birth / to be born
<i>n-h-r / Aph.</i>	ܠܠܬܐܠܐܬܐ* / ܠܠܬܐܠܐܬܐ	nahhar / 'etnahhar* enlightened	illuminate / to be illumined,
<i>m-l-y</i>	ܠܠܡܠܐ* / ܠܠܡܠ	mlā / 'etmlī* f	ill / to be filled
<i>p-r-š / Aph.</i>	ܠܠܦܪܫܐ* / ܠܠܦܪܫܐ	'aprash / 'etpreš* s separated	eparate, distinguish / to be
'-h-d	ܠܠܠܬܐܠܐܬܐ* / ܠܠܠܬܐܠܐܬܐ	'aḥad / 'et 'aḥed*	unite / to be united
<i>ḥ-l-m</i>	ܠܠܠܡܠܐ* / ܠܠܠܡܠܐ	ḥelam / 'eḥelam*	dream / to be dreamed

Additional words

SYRIAC (ESTRANGELA)	TRANSLITERATION	PART OF SPEECH	MEANING
ܠܠܡܠܐ	madd' ā	m. noun	knowledge, mind (root y-d-')
ܠܠܠܬܐܠܐܬܐ	'armlūtā	f. noun	widowhood
ܠܠܡܠܐ	'esbā	m. noun	grass, herb
ܠܠܦܬܐܠ	'ašpel	verb (Aphel)	to humble, bring low (root š-p-l)
ܠܠܬܐܠܐܬܐ	ḥṭtā	f. noun	sin (root ḥ-t-y)

SECTION 7: THE STORY — PART 10

Yukhannan Is Thrown into the Fire — and Saved

The narrative continues from Lesson 9. Yukhannan has been bound and dragged to the furnace. Now the passive voice dominates the story: things happen *to* Yukhannan — he is thrown, he is saved, the miracle is revealed to the city. The story showcases Ethpeel, Ettaphal, and passive participle forms throughout.

Full Syriac Text with Interlinear Gloss:

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	WORD GLOSS	ENGLISH
ܠܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ 'attūnā	w- 'etremy Yūḥannan an Yukhannan in	d-was.thrown An to- furnace thrown into	d Yukhannan was the furnace.
ܠܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ leh	w-nūrā lā qrebet a it.approache	nd-fire.the not B d to.him not approach	ut the fire did him.
* ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ,ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ Ḥananyā w-ḥa	'ayk d- 'et ' bed ' am a brāw(hy)* Hananiah	s that-was.done with J with Hanania and- companions-his	ust as it was done h and his companions.
* ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ d-nūr b-gaw	'ethzī gēr gabrā w 'attūnā* of.fire in-m	as.seen for man F idst was seen in furnace.the	or a man of fire the midst of the furnace.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ men nūhreh	w-Yūḥannan 'etnahhar a was.illumine	nd-Yūḥannan An d from illuminated by light-his	d Yukhannan was his light.
* ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ paršūpeh 'ay	w-kad nepaq 'ethzī a k šemšā* was.seen fac	nd-when he.went.out A e- his like out, his fac sun	nd when he came e was seen like the sun.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ d-neḥzē	kulleh kansā 'etknaš a was.gathered	ll crowd.the A to.see gathered to	ll the crowd was see.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ 'etyāde ' b-k	w-rabbā 'attā a ulleh was.made.kno mdintā*	nd-great sign A wn in-all was made kno city.the	nd the great sign wn in all the city.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ 'etpanīw	saggi 'ē dḥelw m and- they.tur	any they.feared M ned.back repented.	any feared and
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ 'Alāhā d-Yūḥ	w- 'āmrīn: brīk hū a annan* is God of-Yūḥ	nd-they.say: blessed A annan 'Blessed is th	nd they said: e God of Yukhannan!'
* ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ,ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ men 'īdī	w-Yūḥannan 'etpraq an was.redeemed ba ' eldabbāw(hy)*	d-Yūḥannan And from saved from t hands.of enemies-his	Yukhannan was he hands of his enemies.
ܡܢ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ ܕܝܫܢܐ 'Alāhā	w-šubḥā 'etyahab a to- God	nd-glory was.given A to God.	nd glory was given

Smooth English Translation:

And Yuxhannan was thrown into the furnace. But the fire did not approach him — just as it was done with Hananiah and his companions. For a man of fire was seen in the midst of the furnace, and Yuxhannan was illumined by his light. When he came out, his face was seen like the sun. All the crowd was gathered to see. And the great sign was made known in all the city. Many feared and repented. And they said: ‘Blessed is the God of Yuxhannan!’ And Yuxhannan was saved from the hands of his enemies, and glory was given to God.

Biblical Allusion: The reference to Ḥananyā and his companions (Hananiah/Shadrach — cf. Dan 3) is intentional. This is a common hagiographic motif in Syriac martyr literature: the saint re-enacts biblical miracles.

SECTION 8: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

Identify the stem of each verb form (Peal, Paael, Aphel, Ethpeel, Etpaael, or Ettaphal) and give its basic meaning.

1. 'etq̄tel ܐܬܩܬܝܠ
2. 'etbarrak ܐܬܒܪܟܝܠ
3. 'eštaddar ܐܬܫܕܕܝܠ
4. metq̄tel ܡܬܩܬܝܠ
5. 'etpraq ܐܬܦܪܩܝܠ
6. 'et 'med ܐܬܡܝܕܝܠ
7. 'ettaqam ܐܬܬܩܡܝܠ
8. brīk ܒܪܝܟ
9. 'etnahhar ܐܬܢܗܗܪܝܠ
10. 'etmšah ܐܬܡܫܗܝܠ
11. 'etyallap ܐܬܝܠܠܦܝܠ
12. 'etpreš ܐܬܦܪܝܬܝܠ

Exercise 2: Active to Passive Transformation

Rewrite each active sentence in the passive voice using the appropriate Et-stem. Adjust agreement as needed.

13. malkā qṭal l-gawrā — the king killed the man.
14. kāhnā barrek l-‘ammā — the priest blessed the people.
15. šadar malkā estraṭyōṭā — the king sent the soldiers.
16. ‘Ayī ‘aḥyī l-ḥalīšā — the healer saved the weak man.
17. yallep rabbā tlāmīdē — the teacher taught the disciples.
18. ‘aqīm l- ‘mītā — he raised the dead man.

Exercise 3: Translation — Syriac to English

Translate each sentence into smooth English.

19. ܐܪܡܝܐ ܕܡܠܟܐ ܩܬܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
20. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܪܝܢܐ ܩܒܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
21. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܪܝܢܐ ܩܒܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
22. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܪܝܢܐ ܩܒܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
23. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܪܝܢܐ ܩܒܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
24. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܪܝܢܐ ܩܒܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
25. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܪܝܢܐ ܩܒܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ
26. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܕܡܪܝܢܐ ܩܒܠ ܕܥܡܪܐ

Exercise 4: Production — English to Syriac

Write each sentence in Syriac (Estrangela + transliteration).

27. He was baptized in the river.

28. The soldiers were sent to the city.
29. The dead man was raised.
30. She was healed by the saint.
31. The word of God was heard in all the land.
32. He was crowned by the king.

Exercise 5: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 7 and answer the following questions in English.

33. What happened when Yukhannan was thrown into the furnace?
34. What was the biblical parallel mentioned in the story?
35. What was seen in the midst of the furnace?
36. How did the people of the city respond to the miracle?
37. What phrase do the people use to glorify God? Translate it word for word.

SECTION 9: ANSWER KEY

Exercise 1: Stem Identification

38. 'etqṭel — Ethpeel (passive of Peal) — 'he was killed'
39. 'etbarrak — Etpaael (passive/reflexive of Paael) — 'he was blessed'
40. 'eštaddar — Etpaael (passive of Paael šaddar) — 'he was sent'; note metathesis of t after š
41. metqṭel — Ethpeel participle — 'being killed'
42. 'etpraq — Ethpeel — 'he was redeemed/saved'
43. 'et 'med — Ethpeel — 'he was baptized'
44. 'ettaqam — Ettaphal (passive of Aphel 'aqīm) — 'he was raised'
45. brīk — Peal passive participle — 'blessed' (adjective)

46. 'etnahhar — Etpaael (passive of Paael nahhar 'illumine') — 'he was illumined'
47. 'etmšaḥ — Ethpeel — 'he was anointed'
48. 'etyallap — Etpaael (passive of Paael yallep) — 'he was taught / he learned'
49. 'etpreš — Ethpeel — 'he was separated'

Exercise 2: Active to Passive

50. 'etqṭel gawrā (l-malkā) — The man was killed (by the king).
51. 'etbarrak 'ammā (l-kāhnā) — The people were blessed (by the priest).
52. 'eštadrw estrāṭyōṭā — The soldiers were sent.
53. 'eṭḥayyī ḥalīšā — The weak man was saved.
54. 'etyalpw tlāmīdē — The disciples were taught.
55. 'ettaqam 'mītā — The dead man was raised.

Exercise 3: Translation

56. He was thrown into the fire.
57. He was saved/redeemed from (his) enemies.
58. The light was revealed in the darkness.
59. The crowd was gathered in the city.
60. The Messiah was crucified and buried.
61. The Son of God was born.
62. He is killed / he was killed on account of our sins.
63. His voice was heard in every place.

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

64. אֵל מֵד בְּנֹהַר 'et 'med b-nahrā

65. אֶשְׁטָדְרַו אֶסְטְרָטְיֹוֹתֶי ל־מְדִינָתָא 'eštadrw estrātyōtē l-mdīntā

66. ཀུལ་ཤུཌིཌིཀ་ 'ettaqam mītā

67. ܠܬܝܬܝܢ ܕܥܡܪܝܢ 'et 'asīt men qaddīšā (f.)

68. אֵשְׁמָא מַלְטָא דְּאַלְהָא בְּכֻלָּא אֵרָא 'eštma' maltā d- 'Alāhā b-kullā ar 'ā

69. ነገሥት ማርያም 'etkallal men malkā

Exercise 5: Comprehension

70. The fire did not approach him — he was unharmed.

71. Hananiah (Shadrach) and his companions in the fiery furnace (Daniel 3).

72. A man of fire (an angelic figure) was seen in the midst of the furnace.

73. Many feared and repented, and said 'Blessed is the God of Yuxhannan!'

74. 'Brīk hū 'Alāhā d-Yukhannan' — Blessed (is) he, the God of Yukhannan. Word-for-word: brīk = blessed; hū = he (is); 'Alāhā = God.the; d- = of; Yukhannan = Yukhannan.

SECTION 10: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY BOX

Complete Table of All Six Syriac Verbal Stems

This is the master reference table for all six Syriac stems. Memorise the patterns, the characteristic prefixes, and the cross-linguistic equivalents.

STEM	PERF. 3MSG	PARTICIPLE	PREFIX	MEANING / FUNCTION
Peal ܦܥܠ	q̄tal ܩܬܐܠ	qāṭel ܩܬܐܠ	(none)	Basic active: 'he killed'
Paael ܦܥܥܠ	qaṭtel ܩܬܬܐܠ	mqaṭtel ܩܬܬܐܠܡܩܬܬܐܠ	doubling	Intensive / denominative: 'he slew repeatedly / he executed'
Aphel ܦܥܠܐ	'aṣṣel ܐܥܥܬܐܠ	maṣṣel ܡܥܥܬܐܠ	'a-	Causative: 'he caused to kill'
Ethpeel ܦܥܬܐܠ	'etq̄tel ܐܬܩܬܐܠ	metq̄tel ܡܬܩܬܐܠ	'et-	Passive/reflexive of Peal: 'he was killed'
Etpaael ܦܥܬܥܐܠ	'etqaṭṭal ܐܬܩܬܬܐܠ	metqaṭṭal ܡܬܩܬܬܐܠ	'etpa-	Passive/reflexive of Paael: 'he was executed'
Ettaphal ܦܥܬܦܐܠ	'ettaq̄tal ܐܬܩܬܐܠ	mettaq̄tal ܡܬܩܬܐܠ	'etta-	Passive of Aphel: 'he was caused to be killed'

Passive Participle Pattern

Peal Passive Participle

Pattern: CCīC (or CāCoC in some vocalization traditions)

Agrees in gender and number with noun (like any adjective)

m.sg.: ktīb ܟܬܒܐ / f.sg.: ktībtā ܟܬܒܬܐ / m.pl.: ktībīn ܟܬܒܝܢ / f.pl.: ktībān ܟܬܒܝܢ

Used predicatively in verbless clauses: gawrā q̄lā = 'the man is killed'

Compare: Arabic maf'ūl (مَكْتُوب maktūb 'written'); Hebrew qāṭūl (קָטוּל)

Ethpeel Phonological Rules

Assimilation & Metathesis in Ethpeel

Before sibilants (z, s, š, ṣ): METATHESIS — *t* moves after the sibilant

'et- + š-m- → 'eštma (not * 'etšma)

Before dentals (d, t): ASSIMILATION — *t* assimilates to the following letter

'et- + d-k-y → 'eddkī

Before all other consonants: no change — 'et- + q-ṭ-l → 'etqṭel

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Section 11: Additional Vocabulary

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
ܩܪܝܬܐ	qritā	f	village
ܠܫܢܐ	leššānā	m	tongue, language
ܝܠܕܐ	garmā	m	bone
ܟܦܐ	kēpā	f	stone, rock
ܡܝܐ	mayyā	m.pl	water
ܢܘܢܐ	nūnā	m	fish
ܡܕܝܬܐ	mdittā	f	city
ܫܡܫܐ	šemšā	m	sun
ܕܠܝܬܐ	tar'ā	m	door, gate
ܡܫܗܐ	mešhā	m	oil